

Analysis of political power



Although much political philosophy is concerned with theories of the ideal state and arguments about the role of government within such a state, it may also cast a critical eye over existing political systems. Noam Chomsky had been attracted to left-wing and anarchist politics from an early age, and after making his name in linguistics (see [Universal grammar](#)) turned his attention to political philosophy. As a moral philosopher, he believed in applying the same standards of morality to ourselves as to other people, and in politics we should do likewise, examining the morality of all states, especially our own. We have a tendency to assume our home state acts more

ethically than others, because we examine not the actions, but the rhetoric of our own government, and find it easier to accept it than question whether it is being put into practice. In any state, however, there is a discrepancy between the government's political claims and its actions, and this is no less true for the state we happen to live in, so we must make an objective analysis of the way our government exerts political power.